

LAB 1.2 – Create a New Website (Using XAMPP)

Objective

After completing this lab, students will be able to:

- Set up a local web development environment using **XAMPP**
- Create a basic **HTML website directly under the Apache root directory**
- Access and test the website using a web browser via `localhost`

1. Introduction

XAMPP includes the **Apache Web Server**, which serves web content from a root directory called **htdocs**.

In this lab, students will create their first website **directly inside the root directory** instead of creating a project subfolder.

This approach simplifies the learning process for beginners and allows students to focus on:

- Understanding how Apache serves files
- The relationship between files and URLs
- Basic HTML structure

2. Prerequisites

Students must have:

- XAMPP successfully installed
- Basic knowledge of **HTML**
- A text editor (VS Code, Notepad++, Sublime Text)
- A web browser

3. Lab Instructions

Step 1: Start XAMPP and Apache Server

1. Open **XAMPP Control Panel**
2. Click **Start** next to **Apache**
3. (Optional) Click **Start** next to **MySQL**
4. Verify that Apache is running (green status)

 **Checkpoint:** Apache must be running.

Step 2: Locate the Apache Root Directory

1. Navigate to:
2. `C:\xampp\htdocs\`
3. This folder is the **document root** of Apache.

✦ Important:

Any file placed directly inside `htdocs` can be accessed via:

`http://localhost/`

Step 3: Create the Homepage (HTML)

1. Inside `C:\xampp\htdocs\`, create a new file named:
2. `index.html`
3. Open `index.html` using a text editor
4. Enter the following code:

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
  <head>
    <title>My First Website</title>
  </head>
  <body>
    <h1>Welcome to My Website</h1>
    <p>This is a simple web page running on XAMPP.</p>
  </body>
</html>
```

4. Save the file

✦ Concept Reminder:

`index.html` is the **default file** automatically loaded when accessing a directory.

Step 4: Access the Website in a Browser

1. Open a web browser
2. Enter the following URL:
3. `http://localhost/`
4. Press **Enter**

Expected Output

The browser displays:

```
Welcome to My Website
This is a simple web page running on XAMPP.
```

Common Errors & Troubleshooting

Issue	Cause	Solution
XAMPP Dashboard appears	Default index file still exists	Rename or delete dashboard / index.php
404 Not Found	File not in htdocs	Move file to root directory
Apache not starting	Port conflict	Check port 80 / 443